

Heartbeat

During an average lifetime, the human heart beats tirelessly about 2.5 billion times. Each heartbeat pumps blood around the body to deliver fuel and other vital supplies, and carry away waste products. The more active you are, the more fuel your body needs, so your heartbeat automatically changes to match what you are doing.

WOW!

While you are resting, your blood races out of your heart and into the main arteries at a rate of about 2 in (5 cm) per second.

READY FOR ACTION

If you are scared or very excited, your body releases a special chemical called adrenaline into your bloodstream. Within seconds, adrenaline triggers a number of actions including making your heart beat faster. This sends extra blood to your muscles and brain so that your body has the energy it needs to run away from danger or to fight back.

► **ROLLER COASTER**
Going on a roller coaster ride releases a rush of adrenaline that enables your body to cope with this nerve-racking experience.

